

gymbro

No-Mac Install Guide

Get gymbro onto your iPhone using Windows (or any computer) —
no Mac, no Xcode, no Apple Developer Program.

Repository:

<https://github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro>

Works on Windows and Mac alike · uses the free tool AltStore

1. What is this, and what do you need?

gymbro isn't on the App Store, so getting it onto an iPhone normally means using a Mac with Xcode (see [SETUP.pdf](#)). If your only computer runs Windows, or you just don't want to install Apple's developer tools, there's a free alternative: **AltStore**. It installs a single shared app file (a `.ipa` — the iPhone equivalent of the Android `.apk`) onto your phone, signed with your own free Apple ID, and can keep it refreshed automatically after that.

- **A Windows or Mac computer** (any reasonably recent one — this does not need to be a powerful machine).
- **Your iPhone** and its **charging cable**, for the one-time setup only.
- **An Apple ID** — the normal, free one you already use for the App Store.
- **The gymbro.ipa file** — get it from github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro/releases, or from whoever shared gymbro with you.
- About **15 minutes** for the one-time setup.

Note: You do NOT need: a Mac, Xcode, a paid Apple Developer account, or programming knowledge. This guide assumes zero experience.

2. Part 1 — Set up AltStore (≈15 minutes, one time)

- 1 On the computer, go to **altstore.io** and download **AltServer** for Windows or Mac.
- 2 Mac: drag **AltServer.app** into the **Applications** folder, then open it — a small icon appears in the menu bar at the top of the screen. Windows: unzip the download, run **Setup.exe**, then also install **iTunes and iCloud from Apple's own website** (not the Microsoft Store) if not already installed — AltServer needs them to talk to the iPhone.
- 3 Plug the iPhone into the computer with a cable and **unlock it**. Tap **Trust** if asked.
- 4 Mac: open Finder, click the iPhone in the sidebar, tick **"Show this iPhone when on Wi-Fi"**. Windows: open iTunes, sign in, and enable **Wi-Fi sync** for the device.
- 5 Click the AltServer icon (menu bar on Mac, system tray on Windows) → **Install AltStore** → choose the iPhone from the list.
- 6 A box appears asking for an Apple ID — type in your **own free Apple ID** (the normal one used for the App Store). This only goes to Apple, never anywhere else.
- 7 On the iPhone: **Settings** → **General** → **VPN & Device Management** → tap the new profile → **Trust**.
- 8 Still on the iPhone: **Settings** → **Privacy & Security** → scroll to the bottom → **Developer Mode** → turn it **On** → the phone restarts, unlock it and confirm.

AltStore is now on the phone — you'll see its icon like any other app.

3. Part 2 — Install gymbro through AltStore

- 1 On the iPhone, get the **gymbro.ipa** file onto it — open the link to it (e.g. from github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro/releases) in Safari and tap Download, or AirDrop it from another Apple device.

- 2 Open the **Files** app, find the downloaded .ipa, tap and hold it, and choose **Share** → **AltStore**. (If AltStore doesn't appear in the list, open AltStore first, go to the **My Apps** tab, tap + in the top-left, and browse to the file instead.)
- 3 Wait for the install to finish — a progress ring shows on the AltStore icon.
- 4 First open only: if the phone says "**Untrusted Developer**" → on the phone go to **Settings** → **General** → **VPN & Device Management** → tap your Apple ID → **Trust**. Open gymbro again.

That's it. The app greets you with a short welcome tour, and small green cards explain each feature the first time you reach it.

4. Keeping it alive — no more re-downloading

Apps installed this way stop opening after **7 days** — an Apple restriction on free Apple IDs, not a bug, and identical to the Mac path. AltStore automatically tries to refresh gymbro in the background whenever the phone is on the **same Wi-Fi network** as the computer running AltServer — so leave AltServer open (it can just sit in the menu bar / system tray) and it takes care of itself. To refresh right away instead: open AltStore, go to **My Apps**, and tap **Refresh All**.

Note: AltServer genuinely needs to be running on that computer for a refresh to work — the phone can't re-sign itself alone. If a week goes by with the computer never turned on, gymbro will still expire; just open AltServer, get on the same Wi-Fi as the phone, and refresh. **Your workouts, meals, and settings are never lost** either way.

5. Part 3 — Exporting the .ipa (for whoever has a Mac + Xcode)

This part is for the one person who has already followed SETUP.pdf and has gymbro running from Xcode on their own Mac. Everyone else installing via AltStore can skip straight to section 6.

- 1 In Xcode (open via open `ios/gymbro.xcworkspace` if it isn't already open), pick **Any iOS Device** from the device menu at the top — not a specific phone this time.
- 2 Menu bar → **Product** → **Archive**. This takes a few minutes — it's building a release copy.
- 3 When it finishes, the **Organizer** window opens automatically with your archive selected. Click **Distribute App**.
- 4 Choose **Development** (the only option available with a free Apple ID) → **Next** through the remaining screens, leaving the defaults, until you reach **Export**.
- 5 Pick a folder to save into. Xcode creates a folder there containing `gymbro.ipa` — that's the file everyone else needs.
- 6 Share it: upload it to a **Release** on github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro (same place as the Android .apk), or send it directly via AirDrop, Drive, or email.

Note: This .ipa still "expires" 7 days from whenever it was exported — that's fine. AltStore resigns it fresh with each person's own Apple ID the moment they install it, so the original export date doesn't matter to them.

6. When something goes wrong

6.1 AltStore won't install gymbro, or "maximum app limit reached"

- A free Apple ID can only keep **3 apps** signed at once per device — remove another sideloaded app in AltStore's My Apps tab, or use a different Apple ID.
- Make sure **AltServer** is actually running on the computer and both devices are on the same Wi-Fi network — AltStore can't sign anything without it.
- Re-do the Trust step: Settings → General → VPN & Device Management → your Apple ID → Trust.

6.2 Windows: AltServer can't find my iPhone

- Confirm iTunes and iCloud are installed from Apple's website, not the Microsoft Store — the store versions don't include the drivers AltServer needs.
- Unlock the phone and keep it unlocked; check the cable is properly in.
- Open iTunes once and make sure it can see the phone before trying AltServer again.

6.3 The app icon suddenly does nothing

The 7-day signature expired — completely normal. Section 4. Your data is safe.

6.4 "Untrusted Developer" when opening the app

Phone → Settings → General → VPN & Device Management → your Apple ID → Trust.

6.5 AI says a key is missing

Photo food scanning and the nutrition coach need a free Google Gemini key: go to aistudio.google.com/apikey, sign in, click **Create API key**, then in gymbro go to **Home tab** → **Profile** → **AI features** · **Gemini key** → paste → **Save profile**. The key never leaves your phone.

7. Where to get help

- Open an issue at github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro/issues — describe what you clicked and copy the exact error text.
- AltStore's own setup problems — faq.altstore.io
- Google AI Studio (free Gemini keys) — aistudio.google.com
- Mac users / whoever exports the .ipa — see [SETUP.pdf](#) for the full Xcode-based path.

This PDF is generated from `scripts/make_windows_pdf.py` — edit that file and re-run it to update the guide.